

uniforms, NVA tanks and infantry in trucks rolled unopposed into the center of Saigon. A dozen tanks approached the seat of South Vietnamese government, Independence Palace. With unnecessary violence but a fine sense of theater, the lead tank crashed through the palace gates onto the lawn in front of the building. Minh's government, waiting inside ready for formal surrender, was informed by a North Vietnamese officer that all power had passed into the hands of the revolution and they could not hand over what they did not have.

In the afternoon, taken into custody by the conquerors, Minh was ordered to make his second surrender broadcast of the day. Saigon's new rulers announced the liberation of the city and that the administration accepted unconditional surrender. The war had ended.

282,000 The estimated number of ARVN troops killed in the war.

882,000 The estimated number of NVA troops and Viet Cong killed.



Meeting the press

General Tran Van Tra, deputy leader of communist forces during the final campaign, addresses a press conference after the fall of Saigon. The city in effect came under military rule, with General Tra as area commander.

“Between Vietnamese there are no victors and no vanquished. Only the Americans have been beaten.”

NVA COLONEL BUI TIN, ADDRESSING PRESIDENT MINH, SAIGON, APRIL 30, 1975